EMERGENCY **911**

ROADSIDE HELP

ASK THE BEAR
Scan for help any time you have signal.

BEAR WITH ME
The Ready Kit · Life happens.

This booklet gives general guidance. Your owner's manual and a qualified mechanic have the final word.

BEAR WITH ME

THE READY KIT

Life happens.
Let's figure it out.



ASK THE BEAR

When the book isn't enough, I'm in your phone too.



Scan to snap a photo or tell me what's happening. We'll work out your next step together.

Won't scan? Go to **jessboydd.github.io/bear-with-me**

What I can do → p. 19

ASK THE BEAR

NOTES

MY CAR'S NUMBERS

Fill this in now, while things are calm. Future you says thanks.

CAR · YEAR, MAKE, MODEL

_____

TIRE PRESSURE · DRIVER'S DOOR STICKER

Front _____ PSI Rear _____ PSI

Spare _____ PSI

Has ☐ spare ☐ inflator kit ☐ neither

OIL · OWNER'S MANUAL

Type _____ e.g. 0W-20

Check it ☐ warm ☐ cold

ROADSIDE HELP · PHONE

_____

Via ☐ insurance ☐ car maker ☐ other

INSURANCE

Company _____

Card in ☐ my kit ☐ glove box ☐ my phone

Tire number: driver's door sticker → p. 13

START HERE

Take a breath. You've got a plan.

A light came on p. 4

Time for a check
Tires, oil
p. 13

Not sure what's going on
Ask the bear
p. 18

In danger, smoke or a crash? Get safe and call 911.

WHAT I CAN AND CAN'T DO

I CAN

- Explain what you're seeing
- Walk you through checks
- Tell you when to call for help

I CAN'T

- Know your car's exact specs
- Replace your manual or a mechanic
- Work without signal

No signal? This booklet works anywhere.

Back to scanning → p. 18

SECTION 1 · DASHBOARD LIGHTS

WHAT'S THAT LIGHT?

The color is your first clue.

RED · STOP SOON
Pull over when it's safe.
→ pp. 5–6

AMBER · CHECK SOON
Get it looked at in the next few days.
→ pp. 7–9

GREEN OR BLUE · FYI
Something is on. Nothing is wrong.
→ p. 11

Flashing is more urgent than steady.



BASIC CHECKS · OIL

READ THE DIPSTICK

1. Pull it out and wipe it clean.
2. Push it all the way back in, then pull it out again.
3. Look where the oil line sits.



Between the two marks: you're good.

Below the low mark: add a little of the oil type on p. 3, wait, check again. Don't overfill.

- **Milky, foamy or gritty:** don't add oil. Have a mechanic look.

Dark brown or black: it may be time for an oil change. Check your service schedule.

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

BASIC CHECKS · OIL

OIL'S WELL THAT ENDS WELL

Once a month, or before a long drive



CHECKS

- Park on **flat ground** and turn the engine off.
- **Warm or cold?** Your manual says. If warm, wait a few minutes.
- Open the hood. Find the **dipstick**: usually a bright yellow or orange loop.

Engine parts get hot. Keep hands, hair and sleeves clear.

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Next: read it → p. 17

Booklet sheet 3 · outside
pp. 16 | 5

STOP SOON

Pull over when it's safe. Don't keep driving.

LIGHTS

OIL PRESSURE

Your engine may not be getting enough oil. Pull over and turn the engine off. Call for help.

ENGINE TEMPERATURE

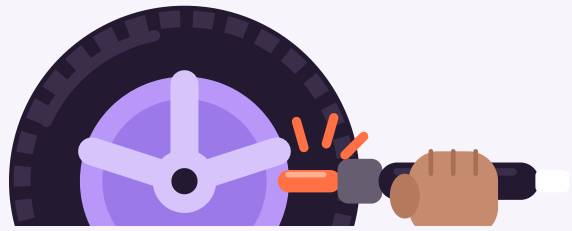
Your engine is overheating. Pull over and turn it off. **Never open the radiator cap while it's hot.** Call for help.

How to pull over safely → p. 12

5

TIRES · HOW TO CHECK

CHECK IT



CHECKS

1. **Check when tires are cold:** before driving, or after sitting a few hours.
2. Unscrew the valve cap. Keep it somewhere safe.
3. Press the gauge straight onto the valve until the hissing stops.
4. Read the number.
5. Screw the cap back on. Repeat on all four tires.

14

What it means → p. 15

Booklet sheet 4 · outside
pp. 14 | 7

CHECK SOON

LIGHTS

CHECK ENGINE

Steady: get it checked soon. Many auto parts stores read the code for free. A loose gas cap can cause it: tighten until it clicks.

- **Flashing:** treat it like a red light.

LOW TIRE PRESSURE

One or more tires is low. Check all four → p. 13. Flashed first, then stayed on? The sensor needs a shop.

First cold morning? Cold air lowers tire pressure, so this light often comes on when the weather turns. Still check all four.

More amber lights → p. 8

7

LIGHTS

STOP SOON

BATTERY / CHARGING

The car isn't charging, so it may stop running. Turn off the radio, heat and chargers. Head somewhere safe now. Can't get there soon? Pull over and call for help.

BRAKE WARNING

First, make sure the parking brake is fully off. Still on? Your brakes may need attention. Pull over carefully and call for help.

Booklet sheet 3 · inside
pp. 6 | 15

How to pull over safely → p. 12

LIGHTS

CHECK SOON

ABS · ANTI-LOCK BRAKES

Your normal brakes still work, but the anti-lock part may not. Get it checked soon.

On with the red brake light? Treat it as stop soon → p. 6.

TRACTION / STABILITY

Flashing: it's working right now, usually on a slippery road. Ease off the gas.

Stays on: it needs a shop.

Booklet sheet 4 · inside
pp. 8 | 13

More amber lights → p. 9

TIRES · YOUR READING

WHAT YOUR NUMBER MEANS

Below your number: add air. Most gas stations have an air pump. Add a little, check again, repeat.

Right on it (within 1–2 PSI): you're done. Nice work.

Above it: let a little air out by pressing the small pin in the valve (many gauges have a nub for this), then check again.

Way low, or a tire looks flat? Don't drive on it. Use your spare or inflator kit, or call for help.

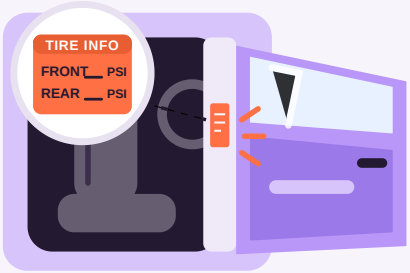
CHECKS

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

SECTION 2 · BASIC CHECKS

TIRE TALK

Every car has its own number. It's in PSI (pounds per square inch).



LOOK HERE: INSIDE THE DRIVER'S DOOR

Not the tire. The number printed on the tire is its *maximum*, not your target.

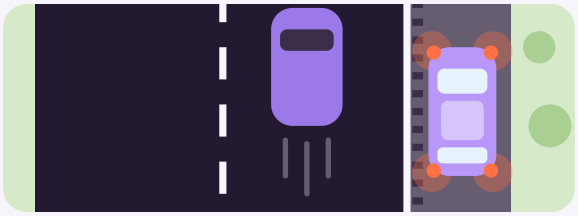
Write it on p. 3 so you only look once.

CHECKS

Next: check it → p. 14

DASHBOARD LIGHTS

PULL OVER, THEN READ ON



1. **Signal and slow down.** Move as far from traffic as you can.
2. **Turn on your hazard lights.**
3. **Put the car in park** and turn the engine off.
4. **On a busy road, staying buckled in is often safest.** If you get out, use the side away from traffic.
5. **Call roadside help** (your number is on p. 3), or **911** if you're in danger.

Still unsure? Ask the bear → p. 18

Booklet sheet 5 · outside
pp. 12 | 9

⚠ CHECK SOON

AIRBAG (SRS)

Red or amber, depending on your car. Your airbags may not open in a crash. **Get it checked soon.**

LOW FUEL

Time to fill up. How far you can go on the light varies by car, so don't count on it.

Oil light or wrench? → p. 10

LIGHTS

DASHBOARD LIGHTS · LOOK TWICE

OIL LIGHT OR WRENCH?

Both mean oil. Very different news.



RED

OIL PRESSURE

Low oil pressure. Pull over and turn the engine off.

→ **p. 5**



USUALLY AMBER

SERVICE REMINDER

Service is due. Book it soon. May say **MAINT REQD**.

Not an emergency

Not sure which one you see? Treat it as red and check your manual.



Just so you know → p. 11

Booklet sheet 5 · inside
pp. 10 | 11

JUST SO YOU KNOW



HIGH BEAMS

Your brights are on. Switch them off for oncoming cars or when following someone.

OFTEN RED, BUT JUST A REMINDER



Seatbelt: buckle up (and your passengers).



Door open: a door, hood or trunk isn't shut all the way.

DON'T SEE YOUR LIGHT?

Every symbol is in your owner's manual. Or ask me → p. 18.



Need to pull over? → p. 12